

MY INNER GUIDE FOR PAPER 1

Example: Are artists still relevant in an age dominated by digital tools?

Planning Stage Checklist

A. What is the Question Angle?	B. What are the Keywords/Phrasing Tested? [Do I know what I must do with these keywords?]	
Value-Impact Effectiveness Responsibility Possibility Regulation Justification	1. Important/Importance 2. Valuable/Of what value/Valued 3. Desirable/Desired 4. Worthwhile/Worth 5. Realistic/Feasible 6. Relevant/Relevance 7. Justified/Justifiable 8. Responsible/Responsibility 9. Possible 10. Ever Possible 11. Effective/Effectiveness 12. Success/Successful 13. Nothing more than 14. More than [other comparatives such as 'greater', 'prioritise', 'better to be X than Y', etc]	15. Most 16. Key / The 17. Main/Mainly 18. Should [should never] 19. Still 20. Only 21. Always 22. Inevitable 23. Too (too many, pragmatic, dependent, etc) 24. Truly 25. Really/ Real 26. As long as 27. ...X, but/yet Y 28. ...X and Y 29. ...X not Y

C. Unpacking all the words in the essay question

Subject or Topic	Keyword	Keyword	Given condition /context or Trend	Qn Angle: Value-impact question
Are artists	still	relevant	in an age dominated by digital tools?	
Who are the artists? - professional vs amateur - individual vs collective - across forms (visual arts, music, film, literature, design, games, performing arts)	What does it mean? How should I weave this into my response? - Signals continuity vs change. - Implies a past where artists were clearly relevant and asks whether that status persists despite new conditions. - Forces a temporal comparison (before/after digital)	What are the roles/functions/purposes artists serve? - I must use PAL to help me generate points Parties: Govt, artists, arts industry, masses Aspects: Cultural - meaning-making, identity, critique Economic - employment, GDP/exports, creative industries, IP Civic/ educational – social cohesion, public discourse, arts education, wellbeing Technological/ innovative - R&D, human-centred design Levels: Individuals, ethnic community, national	What are the digital tools? - This is the context for the question and so I have to include it into the TS For Creation: AI image/music models, DAWs, 3D/CAD, code, photogrammetry For Distribution: social platforms, streaming, app stores, NFT/marketplaces For Discovery/Value: recommender systems, metrics dashboards, ads, virality	NOTE: - TS must reflect impact. If it is not captured in the TS, then it must be reflected on the explanation of the TS. - My explanation and evaluation of the examples must demonstrate what, how something has changed the degree of change

D. Translating to Effective Topic Sentences/Points

Stand:

While many argue that digital tools are ushering the demise of artists, I believe artists are not just relevant; they are also aided by digital tools.

OA1: (artists lose their relevance)

TS: Generative AI has allowed the common man to produce art work, obviating the need for artists today.

EX: Generative AI = produce works of art via prompts -> businesses do not need to employ artists + average person does not need to purchase art works -> artists no longer relevant

SA1 (artists cannot be replaced):

TS: The deep resonance or moral reflection evoked by artists require human emotions and thought that cannot be replicated by digital tools at this point.

EX: Art = deep moral messaging and resonance based on common human experience + AI merely creates based on human input -> artists still needed to conceptualise based on their experience

EV/CU: Things may change as AI develops over time, but we are not at that point yet

SA2 (tools help artists):

TS: In fact, digital tools like the internet and social media can even help budding artists reach out to a wider audience.

EX: SM/Internet = wide reach, cross borders -> allows artists to showcase themselves online -> gain a following despite the lack of backing by traditional media heavyweights

Writing Stage Checklist

Introduction	Yes/No	If 'No', why?
1. Have I provided an engaging opening that bring out the significance of the debate/controversy/assumption implicit the question?		
2. Have I provided the dual perspectives relevant to the question?		
3. Have I defined the necessary keywords or scoped various areas of discussion related to my essay?		
4. Have I presented a nuanced stand?		
OV	Yes/No	If 'No', why?
1. Has my topic sentence addressed all the requirements of question fully?		
2. If I have not included context/trend in my TS, is It then captured in my explanation of my topic sentence?		
3. Do I have an explanation that elaborate on the how and why of the key point raised in my topic sentence?		
4. Have I presented 2 relevant examples to illustrate my point?		
5. Have I used my 2 examples to surface insight or evaluation?		
6. When phrasing insight or evaluation, have I presented it as a CU?		
7. Do I have a linking sentence that connect to my topic sentence?		
8. Is there alignment between the TS, EX/TS, EGs used and the insight/EV?		
Rebuttal		
1. Do I have a clear rebuttal or concession statement that addresses the OV directly ?		
2. Have I provided an explanation for my rebuttal/concession?		
3. Have I supported it with at least ONE example?		
4. Have I explained how the example challenges the OV?		
5. Is there alignment between the various components in the rebuttal paragraph?		

For Each SV	Yes/No	If 'No', why?
1. Has my topic sentence addressed the question fully?		
2. If I have not included context/trend in my TS, is It then captured in my explanation?		
3. Do I have an explanation that elaborate on the how and why of the key point raised in my topic sentence?		
4. Have I presented 2 relevant examples to illustrate my point?		
5. Have I used my 2 examples to surface insight or evaluation?		
6. When phrasing insight or evaluation, have I presented it as a CU?		
7. Do I have a linking sentence that connect to my topic sentence?		
8. Is there alignment between the TS, EX/TS, EGs used and the insight/EV?		
Conclusion	Yes/No	If 'No', why?
1. Have I restated my stand?		
2. Have I added value to my discussion?		
3. Have I provided a moral of the story? Ie call to action, point towards a hopeful future or present a piece of precautionary advice?		

Important To Note:

What is CU? (Extracted from Syllabus Document):

For the purposes of assessing this skill within this syllabus, the definition of this term is as follows:

- make observations of trends and relationships as well as connections across issues and ideas
- apply or adapt ideas to other contexts where appropriate and relevant, for example, changes in time and/or place
- analyse and evaluate issues of local, regional and global significance, and their implications on the individual and society (where relevant).

How do we ensure there is balance in the essay?

1. Overall, beside the SVs, there is **at least 1 strong and fully developed OV** that follows immediately with a **valid and strong rebuttal/concession** (For students aiming to secure a clear pass – Mid Band 3)
2. **PLUS** In each SVs, **evaluative balance** is attempted. (For students striving for Band 4 and beyond)
 - Acknowledge [in TS, Ex/TS, Insights from examples] exceptions/variation in terms of:
 - Context
 - Stakeholders
 - Time
 - Type / way / method

From Cambridge Report [These comments explain why the need for all the components reflected in the checklist.]:

On EV: “Stronger essays referred to and analysed a wide range of well-chosen examples. They used examples effectively to illustrate trends, contrasts, corroboration and exceptions, and to demonstrate understanding of the likely variation in time and place, the gap between theory/the ideal and reality, or the perspectives of various stakeholders.”

On CU: “...the strongest responses included a wide range of contexts and insightful illustrations, and they were more analytical and discursive than descriptive in their approach. They tended to consider the issues from a number of perspectives, such as those of different stakeholders and in different contexts in place and time, thereby demonstrating evidence of conceptual understanding.”

On Balance – Why/How Balance is Lacking - “Most responses acknowledged balance, but this was generally quite quickly dismissed and refuted, in many after a single (brief) paragraph, either following the introduction or preceding the conclusion. While more critical, analytical and evaluative viewpoints were expressed in the balance sections of several of the questions, the attempted balance of some questions tended to produce unfocused discussion of material not completely relevant to the essence of the question.”